CAUSE FOR CHEER

What better way to raise a state's spirits than to promise a return to alcohol? If Prashant Kishor pledged to dump Bihar's nine-year-old alcohol ban should his party come to power, RJD leader **Tejashwi Yadav** slipped in a caste card too. On April 27, he vowed to remove *taadi*, the traditional palm wine, out of prohibition's ambit, a move that should cheer Bihar's 1 per cent Pasi community. Cases against those arrested for selling *taadi* would be withdrawn and industry status also accorded. Could one possibly ask for more?



And that's a...Goal

TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee has scored a goal, without firing a shot. The Diamond Harbour Football Club (DHFC), of which he is the chief patron, has clinched the I-League 2 title this season without a single defeat. Winning 11 matches and drawing 5 out of 16, the club has now earned a well-deserved promotion to the I-League for the next season. Though a grand victory parade was planned, it was postponed as a mark of respect for the victims of the Pahalgam attack. There'll always be a next time.



ALL HAIL THE NETA

Newfound respect for their elected reps? Call it what you will, the Madhya Pradesh police on April 24 asked its personnel to salute MPs and MLAs when in uniform. The Opposition Congress was quick to quip that MPs and MLAs didn't need the privilege; the police could salute the people they serve. Perhaps stung, CM **Mohan Yadav** convened a meeting of top cops on April 26 seeking the rationale behind the order. They also discussed withdrawing the order, given the muted opposition from within police ranks and the bad PR outside. Last heard, the MP police are going ahead.



Kaushik Deka with Avaneesh Mishra, Rahul Noronha, Amitabh Srivastava and Arkamoy Datta Majumdar

HEALTH WATCH

Yes, Malnutrition Diabetes Exists

By **Sonali Acharjee**

We are far from understanding diabetes, it seems. Last week, a new type was recognised—well, re-recognised. Known previously as malnutrition-related diabetes, the WHO had first put it on its list of diseases in 1985, and then dropped it in 1999 due to lack of research. Now, the International Diabetes Foundation has found work done by leading researchers, many of whom are from Christian Medical College in Vellore, compelling enough to accept it as a form of diabetes. It has a new name that validates it: Type 5.

Published in 2022 in the journal *Diabetes Care*, the research showed how its processes differed from the common Type 2, which is linked to insulin resistance caused primarily by obesity. Here, what's at play is very poor secretion of insulin.

"The exact cause is still not fully understood," says Dr Ashok Kumar Jhingan, senior director at BLK-MAX Super Speciality Hospital's endocrinology centre. Probable causes, he says, are protein and micronutrient deficiency brought on by long-standing malnutrition, besides infections and environmental toxins.

"Poverty, limited access to healthcare, and poor sanitary conditions can exacerbate malnutrition and increase its likelihood," he adds. About 20-25 million suffer from it globally; being a poorly understood condition, there is no India data, but we can infer its scale. Treatment entails blood sugar management through medicine or insulin. ■



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